

TURBULENCE AND TRANSITION

INDIA TODAY's first decade began with the Emergency and ended with an assassination and a massacre. If the law of averages dictated that the mood swing towards lightness and levity in the second decade, that was not to be. History's fiat still held more in store.

But trauma-filled as these years may have been, their churn produced more than poison. To retrofit a popular idiom for India, there are centuries where nothing happens; and there are decades where centuries happen. This was one such decade. The 21st century was invented as a vision. The 'two Ms'—Mandal and Mandir—modified the very genetic code of Indian polity and society. Then there was the 'third M', perhaps even more foundational than the other two. Markets. That's where we invested our future.